Grammar 16 B: The passive voice (continued)

1. The passive form of verbs

Every Malagasy verb has a root. The passive form of the verb comes from this root:

- **By adding the prefix A- to the root** *(A + verb root)*

OR

- **By adding the suffix -INA / -ANA to the root** *(verb root + INA/ANA)*

OR

- **Sometimes the root itself**, which is called the 'root passive' *(verb root)*

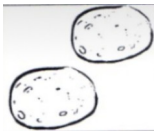
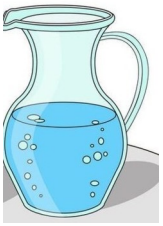
NB: It is good to know these 3 ways, but the most effective method is to learn each verb **by using it and listening to it**.

2. Illustration

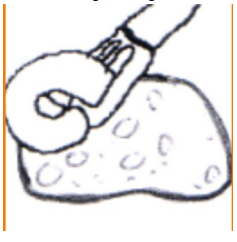
Here is a recipe for 'pumpkin soup' illustrating these 3 passive forms of some verbs:

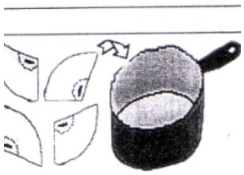
'Lasopy voatavo'
(pumpkin soup)

Zavatra ilaina (ingredients)

Voatavo (pumpkin)	Ovy (potatoes)	Dibera (butter)	Sira (salt)	Menaka (oil)	Rano (water)
					

Fandrahoana azy (recipe)

1. ***Sasana*** ny tànana	2. ***Voasana*** ny ovy	3. ***Tetehana*** ny ovy
		

4. ***Vakina*** ny voatavo. 	5. ***Alana*** ny voany sy tetehana 	6. ***Sasana*** ny legioma 
7. ***Atao*** anaty vilany ny legioma 	8. ***Andrahoina*** ny legioma 	9. ***Asiana*** sira sy menaka na dibera 
10. ***Potserina*** rehefa malemy 	11. ***Aroso*** mafana ny lasopy 	MAZOTOA HOMANA

- The number in brackets in the table below, for example '*Atao (7.)*', lets you find the verb in the recipe above.
- MAZOTOA HOMANA means 'Enjoy your meal!' (Bon appétit).

Active form	**Verb root**	**Passive form**	**Meaning**
Manao	Tao	***A***tao (7.)	To do, to make, to put
Mandroso	Roso	***A***roso (11.)	To serve
Manasa	Sasa	*sasa**NA*** (1. - 6.)	To wash
Mitetika	Tetika	*tetehaNA* (3. - 5.)	To chop
Manala	Ala	*alaNA* (5.)	To remove
Mamaofy (off) / magnofy (tsm)	hofy	*voasANA* (2.)	To peel
Mila	Ila	*ila**INA***	To need
Mamaky	vaky	*vak**INA*** (4.)	To cut
Mahandro	handro	*handro**INA*** / *andraho**INA*** (8.)	To cook

Manisy	Isy	*asi**ANA*** (9.)	To add (to)
Manapotsitra	Potsitra	*potser**INA*** (10.)	To mash

3. Practice

3.1. Try to say the ingredients and the recipe, using the passive form of the verbs, in your own language.

- Ingredients: pumpkin 1- . . . . . .
- Recipe: Wash the hands, peel the potatoes, ...

3.2. Try to reuse the verbs from the recipe, 'sasana – aroso – tetehana – alana – voasana – vakina – andrahoina – potserina', by changing the noun.

Ex: 1. ***Sasana*** ny tànana > ***Sasana*** ny ovy.

. . . . . .



3.3. Translate into your own language:

Sasana ny legioma

asana ny vilany

oasana ny voatavo

tetehana ny ovy

atao anaty vilany ny legioma

asiana sira ny lasopy

andrahoina malemy ny legioma

potserina ny ovy sy ny voatavo rehefa masaka

aroso ny lasopy voatavo.

Answers

3.3

The vegetables are washed

the pot is washed

the pumpkin is peeled

the potatoes are chopped

the vegetables are put in the pot

salt is added to the soup

the vegetables are cooked until soft

the potatoes and pumpkin are mashed when cooked

the pumpkin soup is served.